

SEAG-style practice tests

the catapult papers



the warm-up series

Name: _____

Score: _____

Warm-Up 5

2026 edition

Notes for parents

The Warm-Up Series of The Catapult Papers introduces children to the Transfer Test process in a gentle and accessible way. These papers are intended for P6 pupils and reflect the stage at which schools typically begin early preparation, around eight months before the official exams. At this point in the school year, some relevant English and Maths skills will not yet have been covered in class. Although a small number of these concepts may appear within the Warm-Up papers, the overall difficulty level has been moderated to provide a first, confidence-building look at SEAG-style questions.

As children progress through the Warm-Up Series, they will gradually become familiar with the structure, pacing, and style of SEAG assessments. Completion of this series should help prepare them for the more challenging papers within the main Catapult Papers series (20 papers), which continue the progression toward full P7 readiness.

The official time limit for the Transfer Test is 60 minutes. However, because this is a practice paper, no time limit is printed. Parents may decide how long to allow for completion, depending on their child's needs and stage of learning.

This test paper may be written on, but answers must be recorded on the separate answer sheet provided. Guidance on how to do this is included at the top of that page. An answers page has also been provided for marking. Each correct answer is awarded one mark, and no question is worth more than one mark. Half-marks are not recommended. In the English section, misspelled answers should only be accepted when spelling is not part of the skill being tested. When spelling accuracy is central to the question (e.g. plurals, verb endings), the response should be marked incorrect if spelled wrongly.

Spaces for recording the final score are provided on both the cover page and the answer sheet. Parents may record the result either as a percentage or as a score out of 56.

Finally, please remember that these are practice tests. Early scores are not an indication of eventual performance. At this stage, the purpose of the Warm-Up Series is to build familiarity, develop confidence, and introduce children gradually to the range of skills and question types they will meet later in the Transfer Test journey.

Permission to use this paper is granted for one child only. No photocopying or sharing of the test is permitted. A separate series of The Catapult Papers is available exclusively for schools.

English

In this exercise there are some mistakes with **punctuation** or use of **capital letters**. On each numbered line there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and **mark its letter on your answer sheet**. If there is **no** mistake, mark **N**.

Punctuation Exercise

1 'Photosynthesis is how plants make their own food', explained the science teacher.

A B C D

2 Lost in a world of dream's, Emily imagined a secret portal in her own back yard.

A B C D

3 'I couldn't believe that you'd do such a thing!' exclaimed a startled Jake.

A B C D

4 'Don't forget,' Mum added, 'to text me the very moment you arrive in Spain'

A B C D

5 Once considered to be the ninth Planet in our solar system, Pluto was reclassified as a dwarf planet in 2006.

A B C D

In this exercise you have to choose the **best** word, or **group of words**, to complete each numbered line so that the sentences make sense and are written in correct English. Choose the best answer and **mark its letter on your answer sheet**.

Grammar Exercise

6 The police have took looked spoken wrote taken a note of the
A B C D E
incident and will deal with the matter as soon as possible.

7 They're not going to be attending the party, even though the whole thing was
their there they're them those idea in the first place!
A B C D E

8 The lost city was hidden among throughout through between in
A B C D E
the various dense jungles of South America.

9 Accept Apart Except Aside Besides for Orla, everyone had brought
A B C D E
their permission slip that morning.

10 Lets Let's Let Allow Allows begin our day by reminding ourselves
A B C D E
of what we learned yesterday.

In this exercise there are some **spelling** mistakes. On each numbered line there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and mark its letter on your answer sheet. If there is no mistake, mark N.

Spelling Exercise

11 'I apologise for that disruption. I assure you, it will certainly not happen again.'

A B C D

12 The neighbours were aware of the council's plans. It was common knowlege.

A B C D

13 'The steakhouse isn't a great idea,' said Laura. 'Hannah's a strict vegetarian!'

A B C D

14 The sisters could not contain their excitment at the prospect of meeting him.

A B C D

15 The thunder and lightening forecast ruined our plans for a barbecue on
Saturday evening.

A B C D

Read the whole passage carefully, then answer the questions that follow.

Understanding the Magic of Flight

1. Flying is a captivating and seemingly magical experience, and airplanes are the
2. marvellous machines that make it possible. Have you ever wondered how these
3. incredible vehicles defy gravity and soar through the skies?

4. The Four Forces of Flight

5. To understand how planes fly, we need to grasp the basic forces that act on an
6. aircraft during its journey through the sky.

7. • *Lift:*

8. Lift is the force that works upward against the weight of the airplane, enabling it to
9. rise into the air. It is generated by the wings as air flows over and under them. The
10. shape of the wing, called an airfoil, plays a crucial role in lift generation.

11. • *Weight:*

12. Weight is the force exerted by gravity, pulling the plane down towards the Earth. Lift
13. must be greater than weight for an airplane to rise.

14. • *Thrust:*

15. Thrust is the forward force provided by the airplane's engines. It counteracts the
16. drag that tries to slow the plane down. To achieve and maintain flight, thrust must
17. be greater than drag.

18. • *Drag:*

19. Drag is the backward resistance that the plane meets as it moves through the air.
20. Pilots and engineers work to minimise drag to ensure an effective flight.

21. How a Plane Takes Off

22. Taking off is a critical stage of flight. Here are the steps involved in a takeoff.

23. • *Taxiing:*

24. Before takeoff, the plane moves on the ground using its wheels.

25. • *Lining Up:*

26. The plane aligns itself with the runway, preparing for the next step.

27. • *Increase in Thrust:*

28. The engines increase thrust, propelling the plane forward.

29. • *Lift Generation:*

30. As the plane gains speed, air flows over the wings, creating lift. The pilot increases
31. the angle of the wings to optimise lift.

32. • *Takeoff:*

33. When lift is greater than weight, the plane becomes airborne and takes off.

34. **How Planes Stay in the Air**

35. Once airborne, planes need to maintain a delicate balance between the forces
36. acting upon them:

37. • *Cruising:*

38. During cruising, the pilot adjusts the plane's height and engine thrust to maintain a
39. steady altitude.

40. • *Altitude Changes:*

41. To ascend, the pilot increases the plane's angle and thrust. To descend, the angle
42. is decreased, and sometimes thrust is reduced.

43. • *Aerodynamics:*

44. The aerodynamics of the wings are crucial for maintaining lift. Flaps and slats on
45. the wings can be adjusted to control lift and drag.

46. **How Planes Land**

47. Landing involves a controlled descent and a balance of all the important forces.

48. • *Approach:*

49. The plane descends gradually in the approach phase, preparing for landing.

50. • *Flare:*

51. Just before touching down, the pilot flares the plane, raising the nose slightly to
52. reduce descent rate.

53. • *Touchdown:*

54. The main landing gear makes contact with the runway, and the plane slows down.

55. • *Deceleration:*

56. Thrust is reduced, and the brakes are applied to bring the plane to a complete stop.

Please answer these questions. (Look at the passage again if you need to.)
You should choose the **best** answer and mark its letter on your answer sheet.

16

What are the four forces of flight?

- A captivation, magic, gravity & speed
- B lift, weight, thrust & drag
- C taxiing, lining up, thrust & lift
- D takeoff, cruise, altitude & aerodynamics
- E approach, flare, touchdown & deceleration

17

Look at lines 4 - 20. What is an airfoil?

- A a machine that makes an airplane lighter in weight
- B the force provided by an airplane's engines
- C the resistance that a plane meets as it moves through the air
- D the shape of an airplane's wing
- E the controlled descent of an airplane

18

During which step of an airplane's takeoff process does the pilot increase the angle of the wings?

- A taxiing
- B lining up
- C increase in thrust
- D lift generation
- E final takeoff

19

The word 'takeoff' (line 22) is an example of which type of word?

- A a compound word
- B a hyphenated word
- C a contraction
- D an abbreviation
- E an acronym

20

On which of the following lines in the passage is there a pair of words that are opposite in meaning to each other?

- A line 1
- B line 30
- C line 41
- D line 47
- E line 54

21

What does it mean to 'flare' an airplane during its landing?

- A to raise the nose of the plane a little, just before touching the ground
- B to send out a flashing light signal to the controllers who are on the ground
- C to allow the plane to drop suddenly and quickly, but safely
- D to change the direction in which the plane is facing
- E to open the flaps and slats on the plane's wings, just before touching the ground

22

What one part of speech is 'brakes' (line 56)?

- A noun
- B adjective
- C verb
- D adverb
- E preposition

For these questions you have to **write your answers**, neatly, in the boxes provided on your answer sheet.

23

The word 'deceleration' is used on line 55.

By changing the first two letters of this word, we can create a word that is opposite in meaning. What is this word?

24

Look at lines 14 - 20. What one word means 'works against'?

25

Look at lines 4 - 13. Which two-word phrase means the same as 'important job'?

26

When we add *-ing* to the end of a verb, we create a type of verb that is called a gerund.

‘Taxiing’ (line 23) is the gerund form of the verb ‘to taxi’.

What is the gerund form of the verb ‘to ski’?

27

What two-word phrase in lines 34 - 39 tells us that the plane’s height above the ground does not change?

28

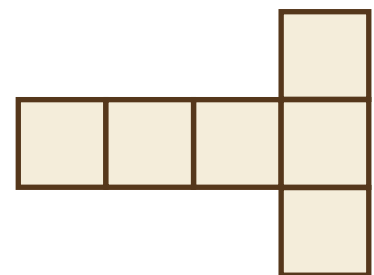
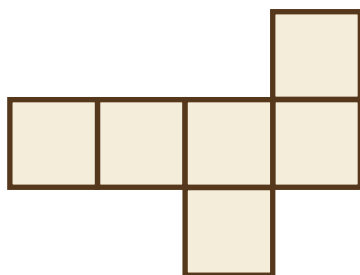
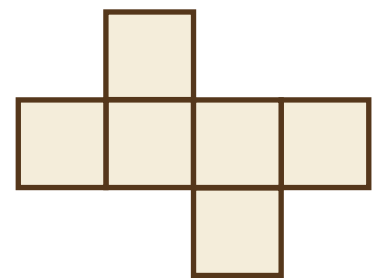
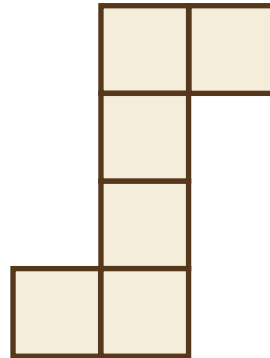
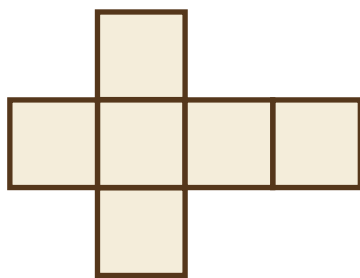
Which one part of speech are the following as they appear in the passage?

basic (line 5), **greater** (line 17), **next** (line 26), **complete** (line 56)

Maths

29

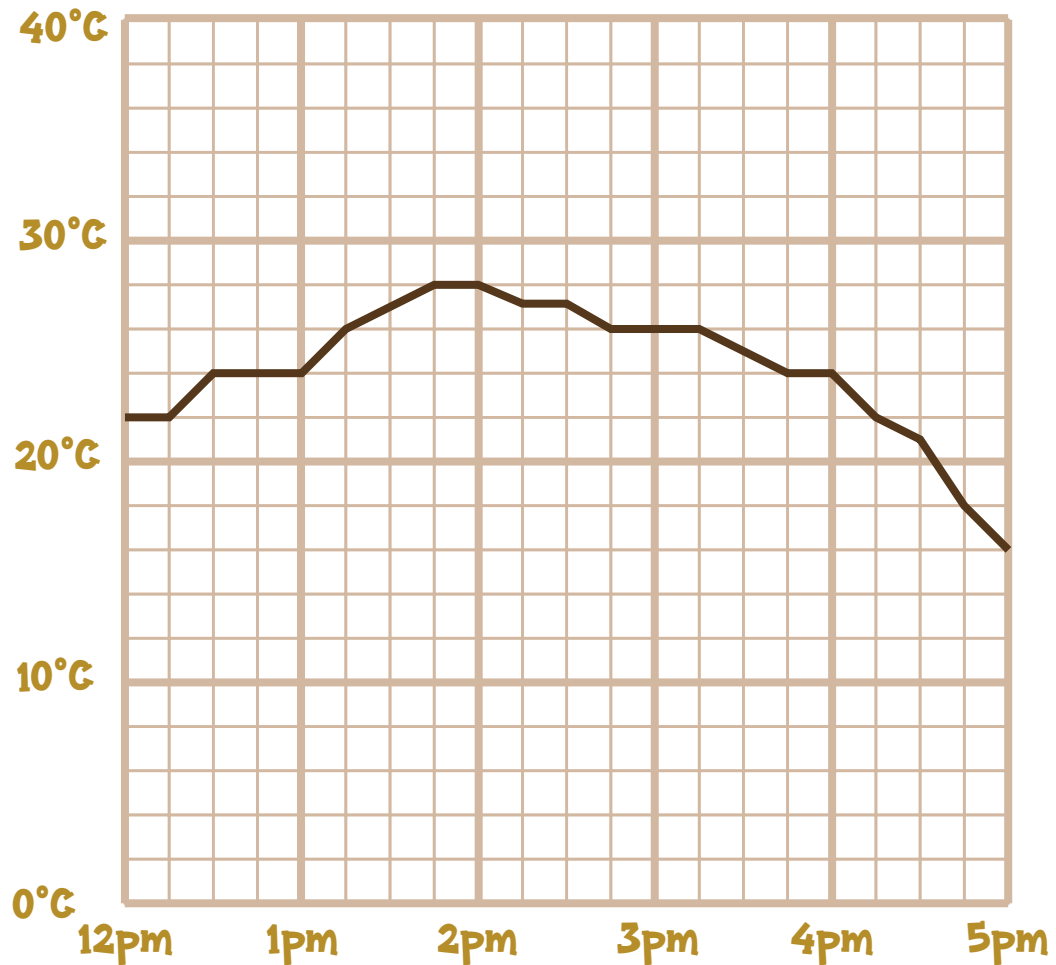
Which of the following times shows twenty-five minutes to eight in the evening?

A 07:35**B** 08:25**C** 19:35**D** 20:25**E** 20:35**30**

How many of these nets can be folded to make a cube?

A 1 net**B** 2 nets**C** 3 nets**D** 4 nets**E** 5 nets

31



The line graph shows the temperature in a garden one summer afternoon.

What was the temperature at 13:15?

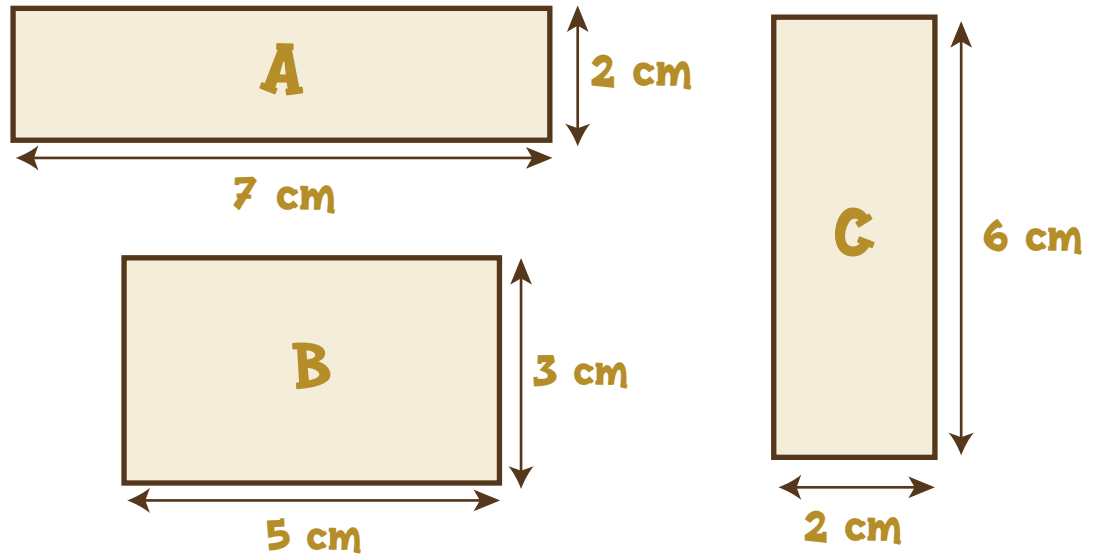
- A** 22°C **B** 23°C **C** 24°C **D** 25°C **E** 26°C
-

32

Which of the following decimal numbers is equal to $\frac{1}{4}$?

- A** 0.14 **B** 1.4 **C** 0.1 **D** 0.4 **E** 0.25
-

33



Which of the following statements about Rectangles A, B and C is true?

- A Rectangle B has the greatest area as well as the greatest perimeter.
- B Rectangle A has the greatest area as well as the greatest perimeter.
- C Rectangle C has the greatest area as well as the greatest perimeter.
- D Rectangle B has the greatest area but not the greatest perimeter.
- E Rectangle C has the greatest perimeter but not the greatest area.

34

Joah turns clockwise through 45° to face southwest.

In which direction was Joah facing before he turned?

- A west
- B south
- C southeast
- D east
- E northwest

35

Which of these numbers is NOT a prime number?

- A 41 B 43 C 47 D 51 E 53
-

36

A dog eats the same amount of tinned food each day. The dog eats 2.8 kg of food every eight days.

How much food, in grams, does the dog eat every ten days?

- A 2240 g B 3400 g C 3500 g D 22400 g E 28000 g
-

37

Leah and Josh are each thinking of different numbers. The number 30 is 25% of Leah's number, and is also 20% of Josh's number.

What is the sum of Leah's and Josh's numbers?

- A 60 B 75 C 105 D 245 E 270
-

38

This table shows the heights of four cousins.

Cousin A	Cousin B	Cousin C	Cousin D
142 cm	175 cm	183 cm	156 cm

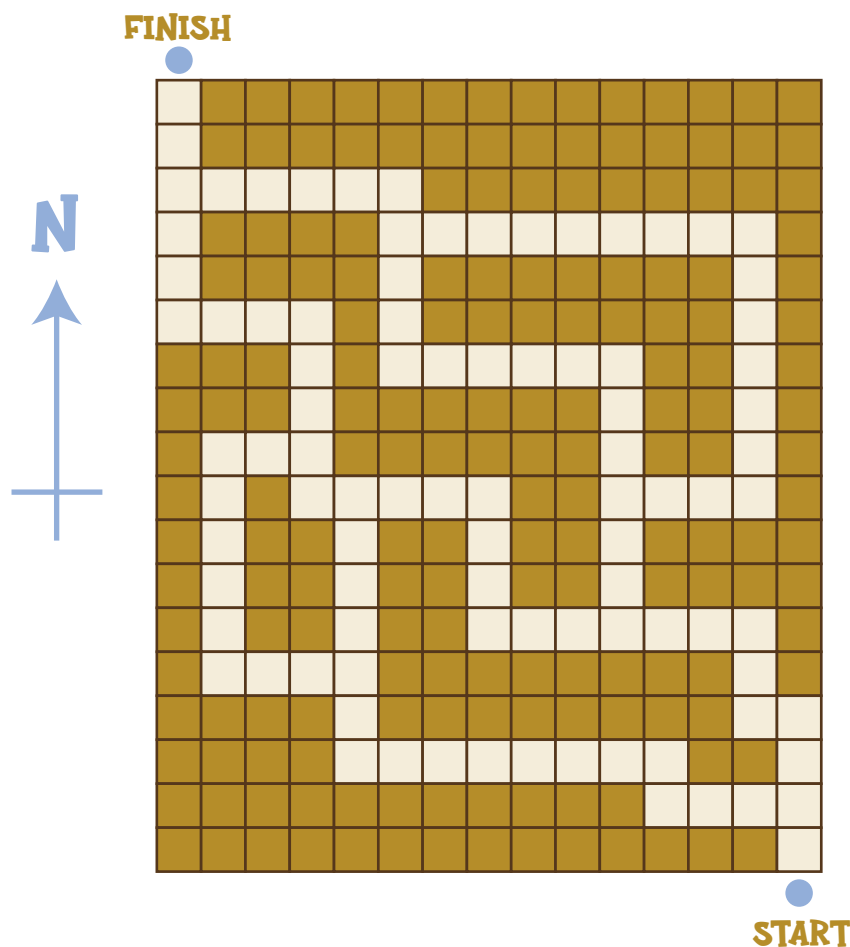
What is the mean height of the four cousins?

- A 1.615 m B 162 cm C 1.64 m D 0.41 m E 656 cm

39

A character must be navigated through a maze. The character begins at the place labelled 'START'. It must then follow a series of directions and arrive at the place labelled 'FINISH'. The character must only follow the light path.

A series of instructions is shown to the right of the maze, but two of the instructions are missing.



Stand on **START**
circle

1. North two squares
2. West three squares
3. North one square
4. West seven squares
5. ??????
6. West three squares
7. North five squares
8. East two squares
9. North three squares
10. ??????
11. North five squares

Then step onto
FINISH circle

What are the two missing instructions?

- A** North 6 squares & West 4 squares
- B** North 3 squares & West 5 squares
- C** North 6 squares & West 2 squares
- D** North 2 squares & West 3 squares
- E** North 2 squares & West 2 squares

40

A box contains five different types of chocolates:

- 12 Chocolate & Strawberry Delights
- 8 White Chocolate & Nougat Squares
- 6 Caramel Swirls
- 5 Fudge Brownies
- 9 Chocolate Truffles

A chocolate is taken from the box at random.



What is the probability that a White Chocolate & Nougat Square is chosen?

A $\frac{1}{8}$

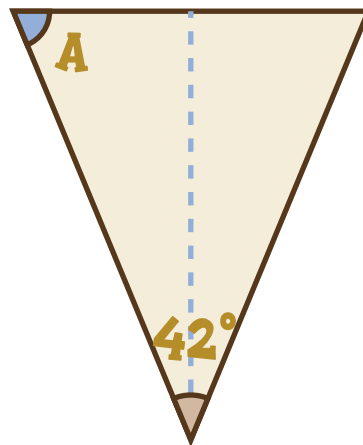
B 20%

C $\frac{1}{4}$

D 16%

E $\frac{3}{4}$

41



What is the size of Angle A in this isosceles triangle?

A 42°

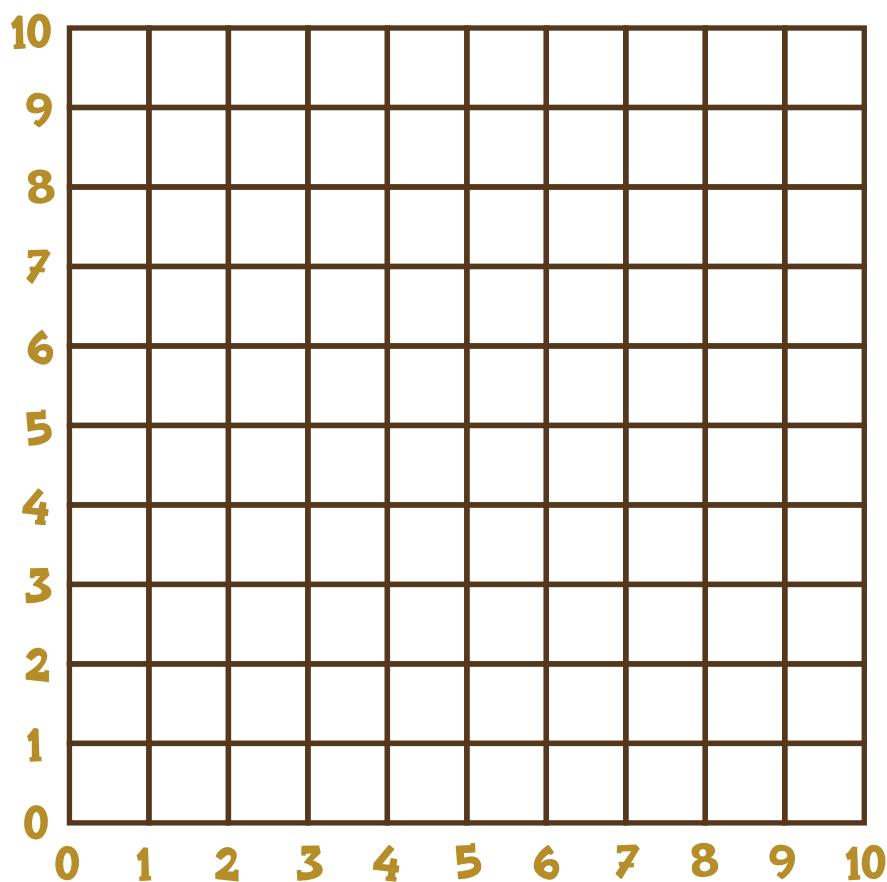
B 69°

C 84°

D 96°

E 138°

42



Which of the following sets of coordinates would form the four corners of a square on this grid?

- A (10,6), (6,1), (6,6), (10,1)
- B (10,6), (4,1), (4,6), (10,1)
- C (10,6), (5,1), (5,6), (10,1)
- D (10,6), (3,1), (3,6), (10,1)
- E (10,6), (7,1), (7,6), (10,1)

43

Which of the following numbers has exactly six factors?

- A 10
- B 11
- C 12
- D 13
- E 14

44

IN	$\longrightarrow$	$\times 7$	$\longrightarrow$	$- 98$	$\longrightarrow$	OUT
96	$\longrightarrow$					?

What is the missing number at the end of this function machine?

A 568

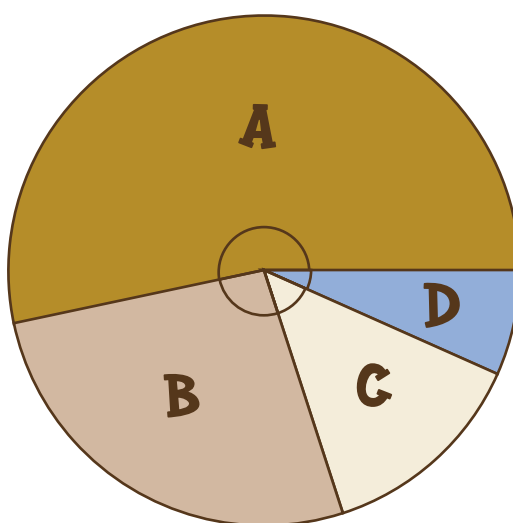
B 574

C 580

D 584

E 590

45



Four angles combine to create a full turn.

Angle A is double Angle B, which is double Angle C, which is double Angle D.

Which, if any, of the angles measures 60° ?

A Angle A

B Angle B

C Angle C

D Angle D

E None of the angles

46



What is the perimeter of this square?

- A 16 cm B 24 cm C 32 cm D 40 cm E 64 cm
-

47

60 is $\frac{4}{5}$ of which number?

- A 15 B 24 C 48 D 75 E 85
-

48



Which of the above numbers is a cube number?

- A 2 B 4 C 6 D 8 E 10
-

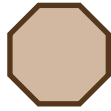
49

Which of the following values is smallest?

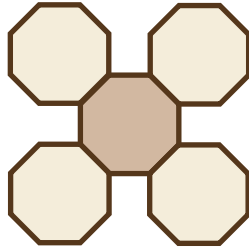
- A $\frac{2}{9}$ B $\frac{8}{21}$ C $\frac{5}{12}$ D $\frac{1}{3}$ E $\frac{4}{15}$
-

50

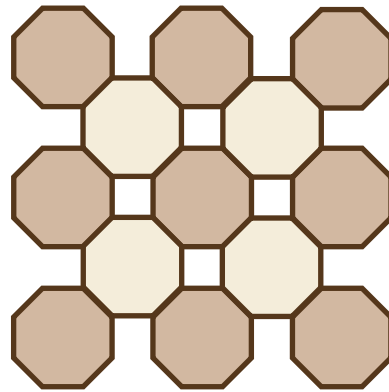
Light and dark octagons are used to create a series of patterns.



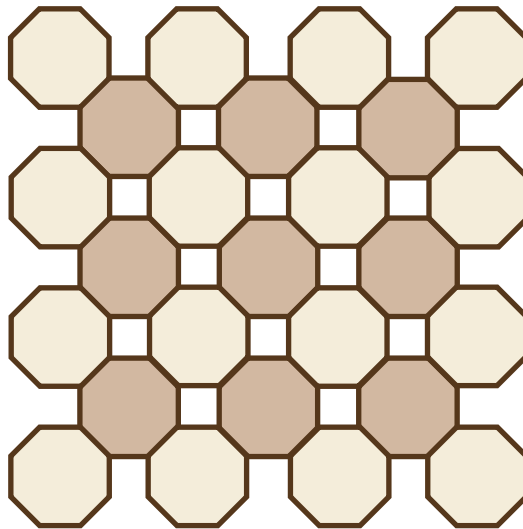
Pattern 1



Pattern 2



Pattern 3



Pattern 4

Pattern 1 has one octagon. Pattern 2 has five octagons.

How many octagons will there be altogether in Pattern 5?

A 16

B 37

C 41

D 49

E 51

For questions 51 - 56, you have to **write your answers** in the boxes provided on your answer sheet. The units of measurement have been given.

51

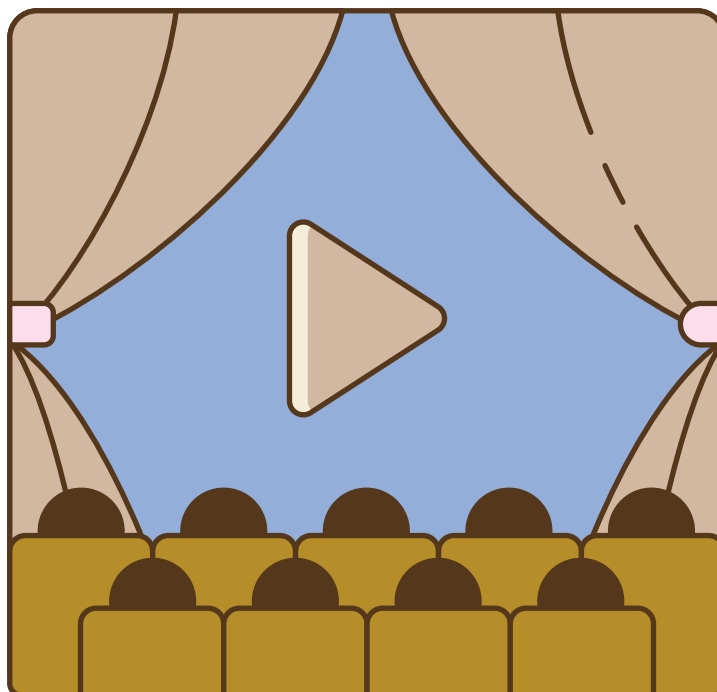
Lewis buys eight jars of honey, each having the same price. He pays with a £20 note and receives £5.20 change.

What is the price of one jar of honey?

**52**

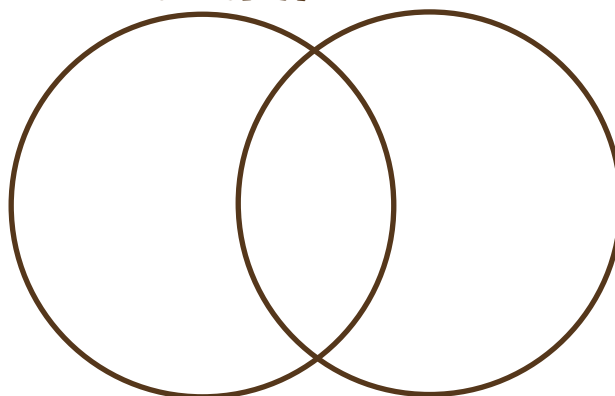
There are 28 rows of 16 seats in Screen Two at the local cinema.

How many seats are there altogether in Screen Two?



53

Factors of 24



Square Numbers

What is the smallest number that **CANNOT** be placed inside either of the circles in this Venn Diagram?

54



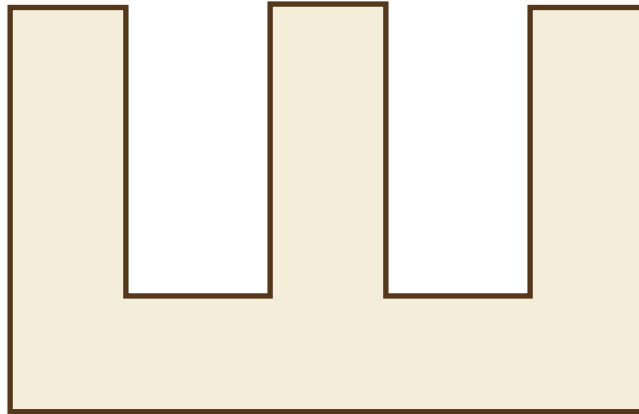
The Year 3 pupils at Basilwood Primary School are going on a field trip to Valleybrook Forest Park.

The bus leaves the school at 9.30 am. The journey to their destination takes 1 hour 35 minutes. They then spend two and a half hours at the forest park.

The journey back to school takes 1 hour 25 minutes.

At what time did the Year 3 pupils arrive back at school?
Write your answer as a 24-hour clock time.

55



How many lines of symmetry does this shape have?

.....

56

8.65	8.8
8.185	8.79

Multiply the largest of these numbers by 1000.

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Catapult is a one-man tuition service. Based in East Belfast, Trevor Veale has been working with primary pupils from 4 to 11-years-old on a full-time basis since 2019.

A former Year 3 and Year 6 teacher, Trevor is now fully booked as a private tutor through to the end of 2030. His teaching resources not only include *The Catapult Papers*, but also *Target Practice* and *Rooted*. All of these materials can be purchased at www.catapult-tuition.com